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Finals Essay Task 1.

C301 / 4-23-26

Assessment on your Understanding as to what really matters to become Data Analysts. And How to integrate SQL into your Data Analysis

Instruction:

Read the attached Article and video link before answering the questions.

Video link: <https://youtu.be/hGCKdMsfU7g>

Article Link:

<https://drive.google.com/file/d/1FhanZgD5YFiBJP0088UbEWaN7DEFbgiE/view?usp=s>

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Following the video that you have watch and article that I ask you to read please answer the ff: question using your own words in 2–3 sentences based on the provided source material.

1. What are the four primary factors that will differentiate a data analyst candidate in 2026?

- Domain Knowledge, Understanding how you fit into the technical ecosystem, Soft skills that actually matter, and lastly Having a strong reason why you want to become a data analyst.

2. How does domain knowledge provide a competitive advantage over purely technical candidates?

- Domain knowledge makes a candidate instantly more valuable because they already understand the metrics, customers, stakeholders, and company dynamics in their field of experience, which purely technical candidates may not.

3. What is the “lean tech stack” recommended for a foundational data analyst role?

- The recommended technical skills include Excel (pivot tables, conditional formatting, aggregation, lookup functions), SQL (queries with joins, CTEs, subqueries, window functions), and one visualization tool like Tableau, Power BI, or Looker. Optional but beneficial tools include DBT and Google Analytics.

4. Distinguish between “learning projects” and “showing projects”.

- 'Learning projects' are low-pressure exercises to practice individual tools with clean datasets. 'Showing projects' are more real-world, involve messy data, combine multiple tools, and demonstrate storytelling and communication skills relevant to business insights.

5. According to the roadmap, why is Python often deprioritized for mid-career data analyst positions?

- Python is not emphasized because mid-career data analyst positions rarely test Python in interviews, and stakeholders often cannot interpret Python code. Focusing on tools that demonstrate business impact is more valuable.

Questions on SQL-Base on the Article Posted

6. Why is establishing the “Business Context” essential for an analyst? What is a Business Context?

- Business Context is essential because it tells the analyst what each row represents, what problem the data is meant to answer, and who will use the output, so the analysis stays relevant and useful.

7. According to the text, how does SQL function as a “flashlight”?

- SQL functions as a “flashlight” because it helps you illuminate the data slowly and spot issues like wrong ages, invalid dates, duplicates, and negative values that should not exist.

8. Why is the validation step considered a professional necessity rather than an optional task?

- Validation is a professional necessity because it prevents embarrassing mistakes, checks for impossible or illogical values, and builds credibility before analysis begins.

9. What defines “good SQL” according to the author’s standards?

- According to the author, good SQL is easy to read, easy to explain, and easy to trust.

10. Describe the fundamental mindset shift required to move from being a student to being an analyst.

- The fundamental mindset shift is moving from “I wrote a query” to “This query answers a business question,” which means thinking like an analyst instead of a student.